

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

31 August 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

The paralegal role supporting a major public inquiry appeals to me for a specific reason: my background at BCLP and Citizens Advice has been almost entirely in evidence-heavy, procedurally complex work, and the core tasks you describe (receiving, reviewing, redacting and disclosing material to Core Participants) sit squarely within what I have actually done rather than what I would need to learn.

At BCLP, I spent six months on a complex investment arbitration where my primary work was reviewing and organising large volumes of evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial. Shortly before a major deadline, I became the only junior supporting the team. I coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions across the matter and helped ensure the submission went out on time. That experience gave me a clear sense of what careful document management looks like when the stakes are high and the volume is large. I also maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout, which is directly relevant to the disclosure and file management work this role involves.

At Citizens Advice, I manage matters from initial instruction through to submission across a wide range of legal issues. That includes taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, maintaining confidential case records and meeting deadlines across several active matters at once. The work regularly involves handling sensitive personal information carefully and communicating procedural requirements to clients who find the process unfamiliar. Dealing accurately and clearly with sensitive material under time pressure is something I do as a matter of course in that role.

What draws me specifically to an inquiry context is that the procedural and evidentiary rigour I have built in disputes work translates well here, but the public interest dimension is more direct. The work of reviewing and disclosing material to Core Participants requires exactly the kind of careful, methodical approach I have developed, and the consequence of errors is genuinely significant. That combination of procedural precision and real public interest purpose is what makes this role, rather than a commercial disputes paralegal position, the more compelling option for where I want to develop.

I am available to start on short notice and comfortable working remotely with travel to London or Belfast as required.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva